Avid Media Composer — Keyboard Shortcuts

DCPR 1610 | Quiz Review Sheet

Learn the function first, the key second. Understanding what each shortcut does is more important than memorizing letters.

1 — Marking & Navigation

Before you can edit, you need to mark what you want and find your way around.

I or E	Set In mark
O or R	Set Out mark
T	Mark entire clip (sets In and Out simultaneously)
D	Clear In mark
F	Clear Out mark
G	Clear both In and Out marks
3 or ←	Step back 1 frame
4 or →	Step forward 1 frame
1	Step back 8 (or 10) frames
2	Step forward 8 (or 10) frames
6	Play In to Out

2 — Core Editing

The four foundational edits — know these cold.

B	**Overwrite — drops source over existing material, no ripple**
V	**Splice-In — inserts source and pushes everything downstream**
X	**Extract — removes selection and closes the gap**
Z	**Lift — removes selection and leaves filler (black)**

3 — Segment Mode

For moving and rearranging clips already in the Timeline.

Shift + S	Activate Extract/Splice-In Segment Mode tool (yellow — ripples)
Shift + A	Activate Overwrite/Lift Segment Mode tool (red — no ripple)
Shift + L	Toggle Link Selection — keeps audio and video moving together

4 — Trim Mode

Fine-tune edit points frame by frame. Trim Mode has its own navigation.

U	Enter or exit Trim Mode
Y	Enter Source/Record mode (also exits Trim Mode)
Shift + D	Select Overwrite Trim (red — sequence length stays fixed)
Shift + F	Select Ripple Trim (yellow — sequence length changes)
A	Go to previous edit point (in Trim Mode)
S	Go to next edit point (in Trim Mode)
,	Trim 1 frame to the left
.	Trim 1 frame to the right
M	Trim 8 (or 10) frames to the left

5 — Effects & Markers

Quick access to transitions and keyframes.

/	Open Quick Transition dialog
'	Add keyframe (apostrophe key)

★ Red vs. Yellow — the key distinction

Red tools (Overwrite, Lift, Overwrite Trim) affect only what you touch — the sequence length and surrounding clips stay put. Yellow tools (Splice-In, Extract, Ripple Trim) ripple outward — gaps open or close and the sequence length changes. If you remember nothing else, remember this.

★ Marks come in pairs

In and Out always work together. T marks the whole clip at once. G clears both at once. D and F clear one at a time.

★ Trim Mode has its own navigation

Once inside Trim Mode, A and S move between edit points — not the usual playhead keys. Think of Trim Mode as its own mini-environment with its own controls.